Theme Release Caching

Assumptions

The corrected article is already live on the server and the fix has been deployed. Some readers see the old version, some see the new. That pattern tells me it's a cache problem, not a code problem. I'm also assuming cache exists at more than one layer browser, CDN, and possibly server-side and object cache.

First three checks

First, I'd try to reproduce it and see the pattern. Incognito window, normal window, phone on mobile data. If I only see the old version in one place, that narrows it fast. If it shows up everywhere I look, the problem is further up the chain. The pattern tells me where to look first.

Second, I'd walk the cache layers one by one, from the reader inward. Browser cache, CDN, server-side page cache, object cache, then the database. I'd hit each one directly and see what it's serving. For the CDN, I'd add a cache-busting query string to check if the origin has the new version. For server caches, I'd look at the host's cache controls and try a purge.

Third, I'd check whether the fix actually reached the origin. If the code was never deployed to production, no amount of purging will help. I'd look at the deployed theme file or the post content directly on the server, bypassing all cache layers.

How I'd tell caching apart from a code or content problem

If the origin is serving the new version but readers are seeing the old one, it's caching. If the origin is also serving the old version, the fix never landed, and that's a deployment problem, not a cache problem. The test is simple: hit the origin with cache bypass and compare it to what readers see.

When I'd roll back

If I can't find the cache layer to purge within about fifteen minutes, I'd roll back to the previous theme release. Readers seeing inconsistent content is worse than the cost of pushing the fix again. When the cause isn't clear and readers are affected, rolling back is the safer move.

How I'd verify recovery

Three things. The article shows the correct version in a fresh incognito window. It shows correctly on mobile data, which is a different network. And the response headers show a fresh cache timestamp. If all three pass, I'd call it recovered, then keep an eye on it for an hour.

Two-sentence update to the editor

We've found that some readers are getting a cached copy of the article, and we're clearing it now. I'll confirm once it's showing correctly for everyone.